

Figure 2.25 *Minarets of Ghazni, distant view. © Photograph Josephine Powell c. 1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

In the process of assigning the Da Qadi *minar* a definitive place within the twelfth-century phase of this cosmopolitan Persianate architectural culture, it is important to note the similarities as well as the significant differences between this tower and its relevant contemporaries, specifically those at Ghazna and in the Sistan and Balkh regions. For it is inescapable that the Da Qadi exemplar diverges from these others in scale, and in the variety and quality of its decorative program.

The Ghazna *minar*s (Figure 2.25) likely measured about 44 meters in height when both the stellate and cylindrical shafts were in place (prior to *c*. 1915; cf. Figure I.20); while the Balkh and Qasimabad towers (Figure 2.18 and 2.19) reached at least 30 meters.[71] Based on the average dimensions of the fired bricks used in such constructions, Thomas et al. proposed that Da Qadi's *minar* could have been between 7.2 and 10.4 meters in height.[72] Further, even though Da Qadi's tower followed its larger *comparanda* in tapering toward the top, perhaps also having balconies in wood or another material, it probably did not have an upper shaft (as